



FURMAN
UNIVERSITY

STUDENT INVOLVEMENT

Student Organization Revenue Guidelines and Best Practices

Updated 8/6/25

Fundraising

Student Organizations fundraise in a variety of ways and for many purposes, but in all cases they should do so with a full awareness of the university's expectations about student fundraising activities. We recommend that student groups be thoughtful in planning and engaging in fundraising and do so when they have specific goals or expenses that exceed their current revenue projections.

Please be familiar with the following guidelines from the Student Handbook regarding student organization fundraising:

- Recognized student organizations (RSOs) are allowed to host fundraising events to support Organizational Activity, in adherence to University policy and federal and state law. Fundraising is defined as any Event in which an organization solicits money from its members or from any other person internal and/or external to the campus community.
- Student organizations must register fundraising events in advance for approval with the Office of Student Involvement (OSI), or relevant administrative office with jurisdiction over the organizational activity of a student group. Student organizations should register these events within no less than a five-business day window prior to the anticipated date of the event. OSI has the authority to deny any fundraising event registration.
- Students are not allowed to solicit door-to-door.
- Lotteries, raffles, and games of chance must be in accordance with University policy and South Carolina state law.
- Student organizations can host Events for a philanthropic cause. 100% of all income generated from a philanthropic event must be given to the charitable organization.

- RSOs are prohibited from co-sponsoring philanthropic events and/or fundraisers in conjunction with any alcohol distributor, bar, or tavern or hosting philanthropic events at such locations. Alcohol may not be served at a philanthropic event without approval from OSI.
- Fundraising events must adhere to the guidelines set in the [Student Business policy](#) and may not attempt to circumvent this policy.
- Funds collected from an approved fundraising event must be deposited in a student organization's University account. Student organizations must work with the Office of Student Involvement to ensure compliance with applicable university policy. RSOs that do not receive University funds are expected to follow all applicable general accounting practices related to managing funds collected from fundraising events.
- Student organizations are prohibited from fundraising for the following reasons:
 1. Funding for personal financial gain
 2. Alcohol, tobacco, gambling, or illegal expenditures
 3. Any item prohibited by South Carolina procurement law guidelines
 4. Political campaign expenses including local, state, and federal elections

Student groups are not allowed to hold traditional raffles, a game of chance in which purchasers **exchange money** for tickets that are then **entered into a drawing** for a prize. However, student groups are allowed to sell items like t-shirts or baked goods, or provide services like car washes, to raise funds for their group activities. The sale of items is not considered to be charitable activity. No gift receipts will be given for such activity.

Non-Cash Payment Acceptance

If your group needs to accept credit card or online payments for selling goods or services, holding a ticketed event, or collecting dues or fees for group activities, we have solutions to help you reach your goals.

Check out the payment scenarios listed below and find the scenario that best fits your situation!

OSI will deposit the proceeds from these types of sales into the appropriate cost center. [Sale proceeds may not be channeled through the personal accounts \(Venmo, PayPal, bank accounts\) of students, staff or faculty.](#)

Nelnet to accept payments for:

- Registration Fees
- Club Dues
- Day of' sales at the door of an alcohol-free event



The OSI Credit Card Reader to accept payments for:

- In-person sales/tabling (bake sales, car washes, etc.)
- Uniform or T-Shirt Orders



Eventbrite to accept payments for:



- Pre-sales of ticketed events such as plays, concerts, etc.

To use Nelnet, Event Brite or the OSI Credit Card Reader, student groups must first register their event on SyncDIN, unless the group is collecting dues. Once the event is registered and approved, the President or Treasurer of the organization will need to fill out the *Fundraising Revenue Request Form* on the OSI page of SyncDIN **at least 7 business days in advance**. Use of the credit card reader is subject to equipment availability, so it is best to request as soon as you know your sale date.

Specific Guidelines for Credit Card Reader

Organizations wishing to use the Credit Card reader must will need to designate specific students who will be responsible for the credit card processors, with a maximum of three users. All responsible users must take a short training and sign and submit a Confidentiality Agreement prior to the reader being picked up.

One of the student responsible users will need to pick up the reader in the Office of Student Involvement, Trone Center Suite 206, between the hours of 9am-5pm Monday-Friday.

The reader should be returned as soon as your event concluded, but NO LATER THAN the business morning following event conclusion. A student listed as responsible party must return the equipment.

You will receive a credit card reader, as well as charging cables and receipt paper, when you pick up the equipment. All components must be returned in proper working conditions. Replacement fees will be charged to your group budget.

Keeping payment devices and your sale transactions secure is of the utmost importance. Your organization's designated responsible parties must assume responsibility for safeguarding the borrowed devices and must always be present when the equipment is being used for sales.

The *Fundraising Revenue Request Form* records the purpose and location of your sale. Using the equipment for an unapproved purpose or in an unapproved location is grounds for permanent dismissal from future use.